

Financial Wellness Consultant: Research and Questions

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I went through the job description line by line. Below, each section quotes the part of the role it relates to, followed by relevant experience and the questions I would like to learn more about.

1. Delivering high-quality financial education

"The Financial Wellness Consultant is responsible for delivering high-quality financial education services to 401(k) plan participants and clients of Creative Planning."

Questions

- How is "high-quality" measured for this role? For example, participant engagement, workshop attendance, follow-up meetings booked, changes in deferral rates, or referrals to wealth management?
- Roughly how many plans and participants does each Financial Wellness Consultant support?
- How are participants assigned? Is each FWC dedicated to specific plans or regions, or do all FWCs work with any participant who reaches out?

2. Relationship-centric financial planning support

"This role combines participant-focused education delivery with relationship-centric financial planning support..."

At Security Benefit and Empower we built proprietary tools, and at Ameriprise we used Envestnet, so I'm comfortable adapting to different platforms.

Traditional planning follows the well-known six-step process: (1) establish the relationship, (2) gather data and goals, (3) analyze the client's situation, (4) develop and present recommendations, (5) implement, and (6) monitor. The CFP Board has since expanded this to seven steps.

Questions

- What planning software or tools does the team use to support these conversations?
- Is there a similar framework or roadmap for financial wellness consultations at Creative Planning, or is that something the team is still building?

3. Connecting participants with wealth management

“...when appropriate, connecting them with Creative Planning's comprehensive wealth management services for deeper guidance.”

From my research, the core wealth management roles appear to be Wealth Managers/Partners, Financial Planners, Financial Wellness Consultants and in-house specialists (CPAs, estate attorneys, insurance specialists and traders). Every firm I've worked with has organized these roles a bit differently.

Questions

- How does the FWC fit into that structure? Is each FWC paired with a Financial Planner, who then works with a Wealth Manager and the specialists?
- Is there an opportunity for the FWC to contribute as part of that team, rather than handing the participant off entirely?

4. Executing strategic education programs

“The Financial Wellness Consultant executes strategic education programs...”

From my research, Creative Planning doesn't publicize a single branded education program. Instead, its participant education appears to be built from four pieces: (1) free one-on-one planning meetings for every participant, covering budgeting, debt, benefits optimization, Social Security, Medicare, investing and estate planning; (2) an annual education plan for each employer plan, focused on engagement, plan health and retirement readiness; (3) monthly webinars plus onsite and virtual workshops; and (4) data-driven outreach to disengaged participants.

I also reviewed the 401(k) and Business Services site and the public resources, including the Insights articles, the financial calculators (401(k) savings, Traditional vs. Roth 401(k), Retirement Income Estimator, Social Security) and the podcasts (Down the Middle, Signal or Noise?, Icons and Ideas).

Questions

- Is the participant education material, such as webinar decks and workshop content, created centrally by marketing, or is it premade?
- If compliance approves, would an FWC have the opportunity to contribute or develop new content? I'm curious what else has been built beyond what's public.

5. Primary relationship manager for clients and plan sponsors

“...acts as a primary relationship manager for assigned clients and plan sponsors...”

The relationship between the FWC and the assigned plans has always been the foundation of this work.

Questions

- What opportunities does an FWC have to build relationships with participants, plan sponsors and HR or benefits contacts at the employer?
- How does the FWC coordinate with the plan's fiduciary partners, whether Creative Planning is serving as the 3(21) or 3(38) on the plan or another firm is, along with the recordkeeper and TPA?

6. Primary point of contact

"Serve as the primary point of contact for designated plans, participants, and clients, providing proactive financial education and advisory support."

As a Senior Retirement Consultant at Empower, I was the plan point of contact. From that role, and from working with sponsors and consultants at Security Benefit and Waddell & Reed, I've seen that every plan defines success differently.

Questions

- How many plans does an FWC typically own?
- What does "proactive" look like day to day? Is outreach triggered by plan data, such as low deferral rates or participants nearing retirement, or does it follow a set calendar? Is there a set cadence of check-ins with sponsors and participants?
- How is each plan's annual education plan built? Does the consultant create it with the sponsor, or does it come from a central team?
- How are plan health and retirement readiness measured, and does the consultant see those results?
- How often does a consultant meet with sponsors and their consultants to review progress?

7. My first 90 days

"Collaborate with internal teams, plan sponsors, and consultants to identify needs and deliver targeted education strategies, including annual plans that drive engagement, plan health, and retirement readiness."

Under the direction of leadership, here's how I would approach my first 90 days, building on my experience as a plan point of contact at Empower and as a liaison to sponsors and consultants at Security Benefit and Waddell & Reed:

Days 1–30: Learn. Learn Creative Planning's education model, tools, and compliance process. Meet the internal teams I'll work with, including Wealth Managers, Financial Planners, and specialists. Review the data for my assigned plans: participation, deferral rates, and readiness.

Days 31–60: Connect. Introduce myself to each plan sponsor and their consultant. Learn what each one sees as success for their plan, and find the two or three biggest gaps in the data.

Days 61–90: Deliver. Present a draft annual education plan to each sponsor, built around those priorities. Start the first sessions, and set a baseline so we can measure progress at midyear and year-end.

Questions

- Does this match how new consultants typically ramp up?
- What would you expect a consultant to have accomplished by the end of their first 90 days?

8. Workshops, consultations, and holistic guidance

“Lead group workshops, webinars, and one-on-one consultations on retirement planning, investing, insurance, budgeting, debt management, and overall financial wellness.”

“Provide holistic financial guidance – covering investments, insurance, tax considerations, and estate planning, and make thoughtful referrals to Creative Planning's wealth management team when deeper support is appropriate.”

This is the part of the role I'm most excited about. At Empower I led workshops and one-on-one consultations with participants. I also volunteer teaching financial literacy to at-risk youth, so I'm used to making topics like budgeting and debt simple and practical. My background in fixed index annuities covers the insurance side, and at Ameriprise I built pipeline for an advisor's practice, so I know what a good referral looks like.

Questions

- What's the typical mix of workshops, webinars, and one-on-one meetings? Is it mostly virtual or in person?
- Who chooses the workshop topics: the consultant, the sponsor, or a central education team? Are the presentations pre-built, or can consultants tailor them?
- How does a referral to the wealth management team work? Is there a warm handoff, and does the consultant stay involved with the participant afterward?
- Where's the line between education and advice in this role, and how does the firm handle the IAR registration that supports the “advisory support” part of the job?

9. No Participant Left Behind

“Champion the firm's “No Participant Left Behind” philosophy by empowering individuals to take informed action toward their financial goals.”

This line is the reason I'm drawn to Creative Planning. Outside of work I volunteer teaching financial literacy to at-risk youth, and that has taught me that the people who most need guidance are often the least likely to ask for it. In my plan work at Empower, the participants who never opened a statement or came to a workshop were usually the ones furthest from retirement readiness. Reaching them takes plain language, patience, and more than one invitation.

To me, “informed action” means a participant leaves a meeting with one or two concrete next steps, such as raising a deferral by 1%, naming a beneficiary, or building a small emergency fund, rather than a stack of information.

Questions

- How does the team identify and reach participants who have never engaged, for example through plan data, HR partnerships, or targeted campaigns?
- Are there resources for participants at different life stages, income levels, or comfort levels with money, such as early-career employees or those living paycheck to paycheck?
- How does the firm measure whether the philosophy is working? Is there a goal for the share of participants who meet with a consultant each year?

10. Business development and service delivery

“Support business development efforts, represent the education team in client and finalist meetings, and contribute to enterprise growth initiatives.”

“Oversee accurate and timely service delivery while maintaining a positive, solutions-oriented approach in a dynamic environment.”

I've done similar work before, but every firm has its own tools and process, and I'd want to learn how Creative Planning does it. At Security Benefit and Waddell & Reed I presented in RFPs and finalist meetings and supported plan conversions, so I'd be glad to represent the education team in that setting.

Accuracy has always been part of the job for me. On the trading line at Security Benefit, I was one of two licensed associates, and part of my role was confirming that advisors were properly licensed and appointed before business went through. Working with participants and advisors, keeping up with regulatory changes was part of the daily routine.

Questions

- What does the education team's role in finalist meetings usually look like? Does the consultant present the education strategy, or support the sales team?
- Beyond planning software, what tools do consultants use day to day, such as a CRM, participant data dashboards, or webinar platforms?
- How does compliance review work for education materials and participant conversations?
- What do the most successful consultants on the team do differently?

11. Licensing and qualifications

“Series 65, 66, or CFP®”

Series 65: passed May 2026, ready for IAR registration.

Series 63: active, extended through 2031 through FINRA's EVEP program. **Series 6:** maintained through FINRA's Maintaining Qualifications Program. **Series 7:** previously held, currently preparing to retake.

Education: RPF I and II completed, CFP coursework in progress.

Experience: about 16 years in financial services, including retirement plan consulting at Empower, institutional plan relationships at Security Benefit and Waddell & Reed, and practice development at Ameriprise.

Questions

- Would Creative Planning sponsor my IAR registration on hire?
- Does the firm support consultants pursuing the CFP, for example through study time, tuition, or mentoring from CFP professionals on the team?